

Philipp Hilbert. *Payment systems and operational hub ownership.*

Positioning, ten years shipping transactional products, from P2P payments to PSP integrations, now focused on owning the full payment hub lifecycle for a fast-scaling operator.

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Dear Growe Hiring Team,

Payment infrastructure is unforgiving: a misconfigured callback timeout or an undocumented withdrawal hold rule surfaces not as a ticket but as a blocked payout at two in the morning. I have spent a decade in regulated, transaction-critical environments, founding Kvitt Payment Solutions and taking it through to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem, integrating PSP flows at Scheidt & Bachmann's forecourt and POS estate, and owning end-to-end delivery at EMIL Group's B2B SaaS insurance platform, and the single most consistent lesson is that ambiguity at the system boundary is always more expensive than the time it takes to eliminate it upfront.

The Payment Product Manager role at Growe maps directly to where I do my best work. Making system behavior explicit, callback timeouts, hold and release rules, gateway configuration, player-facing error messages, is requirements engineering at its most consequential. I write requirements with explicit outcomes, clear acceptance criteria, and well-defined boundaries as a matter of discipline, not process compliance. At CLINET Platforms I cut a roadmap to its top ten percent against agreed success measures and raised user acceptance more than fivefold; at Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing workflows to let data choose the product direction rather than preference. The same rigor applies to a payment hub: I will not guess at what a gateway does under timeout; I will write it down, get it confirmed, and put it in the spec.

The regional migration sequencing is the piece I find most interesting. Defining rollout stages, setting validation rules on small percentages of live traffic, running historical transaction replays, and maintaining clear rollback plans is exactly the staged, evidence-driven approach I used when migrating the Bundesagentur für Arbeit's bare-metal analytics platform fully into containers while keeping a national policymaker-facing service live throughout. Small experiments make expensive decisions safe; that principle scales directly to a live payment migration across regional operators who each have their own support and business stakeholders to keep informed.

I am also comfortable with the cross-system discovery the role demands. Reading API contracts and tracing a transaction independently across eleven systems, player accounts, wallet, KYC, fraud, reconciliation, taxation, is the kind of structured spike work I find clarifying rather than exhausting. I have done equivalent mapping in defence AI pipelines (FCAS), in hospital information system integrations, and in crypto infrastructure. The fintech and payments domain is where I started my career and where my instincts are sharpest.

Growe is building something that has to work reliably at scale, across regions, with real money on every transaction. That is a brief I take seriously.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
